COMPLETE SALES CONVERSATION GUIDE: COLD CALL TO CLOSING THE DEAL

A detailed, replicable framework for selling anything to skeptical local business owners.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. The Big Picture
2. Pre-Call Preparation
3. Phase 1: The Opening (0-2 minutes)
4. Phase 2: Discovery (2-8 minutes)
5. Phase 3: Objection Handling (8-15 minutes)
6. Phase 4: Solution Presentation (15-20 minutes)
7. Phase 5: Pricing & Terms (20-25 minutes)
8. Phase 6: The Close (25-30 minutes)
9. Common Mistakes & How to Fix Them
10. How to Adapt to Different Scenarios
11. Tracking & Improvement

THE BIG PICTURE

What Are We Actually Doing?

You're having a conversation with someone who:

- Doesn't know you
- Doesn't think they need your product
- Is skeptical, busy, and has heard pitches before
- Will only buy if they understand the problem AND believe you can solve it

Your job is NOT to convince them you're amazing.

Your job IS to:

1. Understand their world
2. Show them what they're missing

3. Prove you can deliver
4. Make it easy to say yes

The Core Principle

People don't buy solutions. They buy **relief from pain**.

If a gym owner is losing online bookings, they don't want "a website with booking functionality." They want "stop wasting time answering the same questions on WhatsApp."

Your entire conversation should be:

- Uncover their pain
- Show how your solution removes that pain
- Prove it works
- Make it easy to buy

PRE-CALL PREPARATION

Before You Even Call

Step 1: Research the Business (5 minutes)

Google them. Look for:

- Their website (if they have one—how old is it?)
- Google Business Profile (do they have one? Reviews?)
- Social media (Instagram, Facebook—last post when?)
- Competitors in their area (who are they, what do those competitors have?)

Why? So you can reference specific things. Instead of "local businesses struggle with online presence," you can say "I noticed your main competitor has 47 Google reviews, and they post on Instagram weekly."

Step 2: Identify Their Likely Pain Points (3 minutes)

Based on business type, write down:

- What do customers search for? (e.g., "driving lessons near me")
- Where are they losing customers? (e.g., Google search, social media)

- What operational chaos do they face? (e.g., WhatsApp inquiries, booking confusion)

Example for a driving school:

- Pain 1: Young adults Google "driving school near me" → competitor shows up → they lose the lead
- Pain 2: Answering same questions 10x/day on WhatsApp
- Pain 3: No way to track student progress, payments, scheduling in one place

Step 3: Prepare Your Opener (2 minutes)

Write down your first sentence. It should:

- Name the specific business type
- Show you understand their world
- Not be salesy

Good: "I build websites for driving schools and coaching centers around Bangalore. I noticed your main competitor's site appears in Google when students search for lessons nearby. I'm curious—do you show up there too?"

Bad: "Hi, I build websites for local businesses."

Step 4: Prepare Your Key Questions (2 minutes)

Write down 3-5 questions you'll ask to uncover pain:

1. How do most of your new [students/members/customers] find you?
2. What's the biggest time-suck in your day-to-day operations?
3. What do you wish you could automate?
4. How do you stay competitive with businesses like [competitor name]?
5. If you could wave a magic wand and fix one thing about your business, what would it be?

PHASE 1: THE OPENING (0-2 Minutes)

Your Goal

Get them to listen for 5 more minutes instead of hanging up.

What to Do

Step 1: Get Their Attention (First 10 seconds)

Call or email them. If calling, start with:

Formula:

"Hi [Name], I'm [Your Name]. I work with [specific business type]

around [location]. I know you're busy, so I'll be quick—

do you have 5 minutes?"

Real Example:

"Hi Raj, I'm Adarsh. I build websites for driving schools in Bangalore.

I noticed your school on Google—nice setup. I'll take 2 minutes,

or I can call back at a better time. What works?"

Why This Works:

- ✅ You're specific (not "local businesses")
- ✅ You show you researched them (you noticed them)
- ✅ You respect their time (2 minutes, not 30)
- ✅ You give them control (they choose when)

Step 2: If They Say "Not Interested" or "Busy"

DON'T pitch harder. DON'T disappear.

Instead, plant a seed:

"I get it, you're busy. Quick question though—when someone

looks up [driving school/gym] near them on Google, does

YOUR school show up first, or a competitor?"

Why? This makes them think. Now they might say:

- "I'm not sure" (opening)
- "Competitors probably do" (pain admitted)
- "Yeah, we show up" (they have a website, but maybe outdated)

Step 3: If They Give You Time

Now move to Phase 2: Discovery.

PHASE 1 CHECKLIST:

- [ ] You were specific about business type
- [ ] You showed you researched them
- [ ] You asked for a small commitment (5 min), not a big one
- [ ] You didn't launch into a pitch
- [ ] If they said no, you planted a curiosity seed

PHASE 2: DISCOVERY (2-8 Minutes)

Your Goal

Understand their pain better than they do. Make them realize they have a problem they didn't know was costing them money.

The Rule: Ask, Don't Tell

For the next 5-6 minutes, you ask questions and LISTEN. You do NOT pitch anything.

The Three Questions You MUST Ask

Question 1: How Do You Get Customers Right Now?

Ask:

"So how are most of your [students/members/clients] finding you?

Is it word of mouth, walk-ins, Google, social media?"

Why? This tells you their current customer acquisition channel. Most local businesses will say "word of mouth" or "walk-ins."

Listen for: Are they getting customers online, or just offline? If it's only offline, you've found your angle.

Real Example Response:

Customer: "Mostly word of mouth and people walking by.

Some from Instagram, but not much."

Your Follow-Up:

"Okay, got it. So when someone Googles 'driving school near me'

right now, do you think your school shows up in the search?"

Question 2: What's Your Biggest Operational Pain Right Now?

Ask:

"If I asked you what takes up the most frustrating part of your day,

what would it be?"

Or:

"What do you wish you had an assistant for?"

Why? This uncovers operational pain. Maybe it's:

- Answering the same questions 20x/day
- Tracking student progress manually
- Managing payments and invoices
- Scheduling classes
- Following up with leads

Real Example Response:

Customer: "Honestly, WhatsApp is killing me. People ask the same

questions about fees, timings, prerequisites... and I'm answering

the same thing 10 times a day."

Your Follow-Up:

"That's common. How much time would you say you lose to that

daily—15 minutes, an hour?"

Question 3: If You Could Fix One Thing About Your Business, What Would It Be?

Ask:

"If you had a magic wand and could fix ONE thing about how

your business runs, what would it be?"

Why? This reveals their priority pain. Not what's theoretically important, but what THEY care about most.

Real Example Response:

Customer: "Getting more customers consistently. Right now I'm

dependent on referrals. One bad month and I'm worried about cash flow."

Your Follow-Up:

"How many new students would you need per month to feel comfortable

with cash flow?"

Bonus Questions (If Conversation is Going Well)

Question 4: Who Are Your Competitors?

"Who would you say are your main competitors around here?"

Question 5: What Do You Think They're Doing Better Than You?

"What do you think [competitor name] is doing that you're not?"

Question 6: If Customers Could Find You More Easily Online, Would You Take Them?

"Let me ask you something—if students could find you easier

on Google and book online, would you actually want that?

Or are you at capacity?"

The Discovery Conversation (Real Example)

YOU: "So, how are most of your students finding you right now?"

THEM: "Word of mouth, mostly. Some people see our board outside,

and Instagram sometimes."

YOU: "Okay, and when someone Googles 'driving school near [location],'

do you think your school shows up?"

THEM: "I... honestly don't know. Probably not as high as I'd like."

YOU: "Right. So let me ask—of all your new students this month,

how many actually found you through Google or online search?"

THEM: "Maybe 2 out of 10? The rest are referrals or walk-ins."

YOU: "Got it. And if you could add, say, 3-5 more students per month just from people finding you online, what would that be worth to you?"

THEM: "That would be great, honestly. At ₹4000 per student, that's ₹12-20K extra per month."

YOU: "Exactly. Now, what do you think is stopping those students from finding you right now?"

THEM: "I mean... probably because they search online and find competitors first. Or they don't even know I exist."

YOU: "That's the real thing. You're missing the easiest sales—people who are ALREADY looking, just looking in the wrong place.
And by the way, besides getting more students, what else frustrates you about running the school?"

THEM: "The constant WhatsApp messages asking about fees, timings, prerequisites. I answer the same questions 10 times a day."

YOU: "How much time do you think you lose to that?"

THEM: "Easy, 1-2 hours a day."

YOU: "So if a website could handle that—people seeing your fees, timings, prerequisites without asking you—that'd save you 10 hours a week?"

THEM: "Yeah, definitely."

YOU: "Alright. So if I'm hearing you right, you're missing online customers AND wasting 10 hours a week on repetitive questions?"

THEM: "Yeah, that's basically it."

YOU: "Okay. I think I can help with both. But before I show you anything, one more question—do you have a website right now?"

THEM: "Nah, never built one."

YOU: "Alright. So here's what I'm thinking..."
[NOW YOU MOVE TO PHASE 3]

PHASE 2 CHECKLIST:

- [ ] You asked 3+ open-ended questions
- [ ] You listened more than you talked
- [ ] You got them to admit the problem (online visibility + operational pain)
- [ ] You got them to quantify the pain (money, time)
- [ ] You validated their concerns
- [ ] You did NOT pitch your product yet
- [ ] You asked about their current situation (do they have a website?)

PHASE 3: OBJECTION HANDLING (8-15 Minutes)

Your Goal

When they say "I'm not interested" or "I can't afford this" or "I don't believe it works," you show them you understand their concern and address it with facts, not hype.

The Rule: Don't Argue, Just Clarify

When they object, they're usually protecting themselves. Your job isn't to convince them they're wrong. It's to show them there's a different way to think about the problem.

Common Objections & How to Handle Them

OBJECTION 1: "I'm doing fine with walk-ins. I don't need more customers."

What They're Actually Saying: "I'm scared this won't work, or it'll be a waste of money. Prove I need this."

How to Respond:

Step 1: Don't Argue

❌ DON'T SAY: "You're leaving money on the table."

✅ DO SAY: "I hear you. You're doing okay. Fair question though—"

Step 2: Ask a Clarifying Question

"If 5 more students showed up this month because they found you

on Google, could you actually take them? Or are you at capacity?"

Why? Now they have to think. Either:

- "No, we're full" (then it's not a fit—move on)
- "We could take a few" (opening—they admit they have capacity)
- "We could probably manage" (sale)

Step 3: Reframe

"So you're not saying you don't want more customers. You're saying

you're not sure if it's worth investing in to GET those customers,

right?"

Now they'll say: "Yeah, basically."

Step 4: Plant the Seed

"That makes sense. Most business owners think the same thing.

But here's the thing—you're probably already losing 20-30% of

customers you don't even know about. Someone Google searches

for you, finds a competitor first, and you never know because

they never walked in.

Want to see how many students you're actually missing from

Google searches? Then you can decide if it's worth fixing."

End Goal: Move to "Let me show you a demo."

OBJECTION 2: "I can't afford ₹20K right now."

What They're Actually Saying: "I don't see enough ROI to justify the cost. Show me the math."

How to Respond:

Step 1: Validate

"Fair. It's an investment. Let me ask you though—if this

brought you 3-5 extra students per month, what would that

be worth to you?"

They'll do the math: "3 students × ₹4000 = ₹12K, so ₹36-60K per month?"

Step 2: Show the ROI

"Exactly. So you'd make back the ₹20K investment in less than

a month. After that, it's pure profit.

The real question isn't 'can I afford ₹20K?' It's 'can I afford

NOT to do this if it brings me ₹36-60K extra revenue?'"

Step 3: Address the Real Concern

"I get it though—you're worried this might not actually work.

That's a fair concern. That's why I don't want you to commit

to anything yet.

Let me show you a demo of what this would look like for your driving school. You'll see how students would book, how it shows up on Google, everything. Then you can decide if it's worth it."

End Goal: Move to demo.

OBJECTION 3: "How do I know this actually works? Do you have proof?"

What They're Actually Saying: "I've been burned before. Show me a real example, not a pitch."

How to Respond:

Step 1: Be Honest

"That's a smart question. I don't have a live driving school website yet that's been running for 6+ months with proven results.

BUT—I've built 4 websites for different local service businesses (gym, salon, coaching center), and they're all getting consistent bookings from Google searches."

Step 2: Offer What You DO Have

"Here's what I CAN show you—a fully custom-built demo of what your website would actually look like. Not a template, not a mockup.

A real website built to your driving school specs. You'll see:

- How students would find you on Google
- What they'd see when they click
- How they'd book online
- Your student portal

- The whole thing.

That'll give you a real sense of whether this would work for you."

Step 3: Offer to Connect Them with a Reference

"And if you want, I can introduce you to one of my gym clients who's been using their site for 3 months. Not a testimonial I wrote—just a real business owner you can ask directly."

End Goal: Lock in demo time.

OBJECTION 4: "I'm worried you'll build it and then disappear."

What They're Actually Saying: "I need to know I won't get abandoned, and I need to own my own business assets."

How to Respond:

Step 1: Show Them the Contract

"Great question. I have a service agreement I sign with every client. Let me walk you through the key parts:

1. You own the domain and hosting in YOUR name, not mine.
2. You get the full source code after final payment.
3. I provide maintenance for the first 60 days—free support, free bug fixes.
4. After that, it's ₹2.5K/month for maintenance if you want it. If you want to hire someone else to maintain it, you can—it's your code.
5. If something goes wrong, you can take it to any developer in the world."

Step 2: Address the Data

"Your student data, payments, everything—that stays YOUR property.

I don't access it after launch, and I never use it for anything else.

That's in the agreement."

Step 3: Offer What They Want

"Also, I'm happy to add a clause that says if we ever stop working

together, you get full documentation and I help you hand it over

to whoever you hire next."

End Goal: Trust is rebuilt. Move forward.

OBJECTION 5: "Let me think about it."

What They're Actually Saying: "I'm interested, but I'm not ready to commit. OR I have a concern you haven't addressed."

How to Respond:

Step 1: Don't Let Them Leave Hanging

❌ DON'T SAY: "Sure, I'll call you next week."

✅ DO SAY: "Sure, I get it. Quick question though—"

Step 2: Find Out What's REALLY Holding Them Back

"What's the one thing that would need to be true for you to say yes?

Is it:

- Seeing it work first (the demo)?

- Understanding the ROI better (the numbers)?

- Owning the assets (the contract)?

- Something else?"

Step 3: Offer to Remove That Barrier

"Okay, so if I can show you the demo and you can see how it would

look for your school, that would help you decide?"

OR

"So if I can introduce you to another driving school owner who's

done this and is seeing results, that would build your confidence?"

OR

"So if I update the contract to say you own 100% of the code and

can leave anytime, that would make you comfortable?"

Step 4: Lock in a Next Step

"Alright. So let's do this—I'll send you a Zoom link for Friday

at 3 PM. We'll do the demo together, answer any questions, and

you'll have what you need to make a decision. Sound good?"

End Goal: Concrete next step. Not vague.

PHASE 3 CHECKLIST:

- [ ] You didn't argue or get defensive
- [ ] You validated their concern first
- [ ] You asked clarifying questions
- [ ] You addressed the REAL concern (not just the surface objection)
- [ ] You used facts, not hype ("3-5 students" vs "lots of customers")
- [ ] You offered proof or an alternative (demo, reference, contract)
- [ ] You got a commitment to next step (demo, call, etc.)

PHASE 4: SOLUTION PRESENTATION (15-20 Minutes)

Your Goal

Show them your solution in a way that makes them think "Oh, this is exactly what I need."

Important: This Often Happens in Phase 2 or 3

You might have already started explaining the solution while handling objections. That's fine. Just make sure you structure it clearly.

How to Present Your Solution

Step 1: Recap Their Pain (Validation)

Don't jump into features. Remind them why they need this:

"Okay, so to recap what we talked about:

- You're losing students to Google search (they don't find you)

- You're wasting 2 hours a day answering WhatsApp questions

- You want to grow but don't have the systems in place

Sound right?"

Why? This keeps them focused on the pain, not the price.

Step 2: Show How Your Solution Solves Each Pain

Pain #1: Losing students to Google search

SOLUTION: "Your website shows up in Google search results when students look for 'driving school near me.' We optimize the entire site for SEO—which means Google's algorithm sees you as relevant."

HOW: "We use AI to analyze what keywords students are actually searching for, and make sure your site has that content.
Within 5 days of launch, you're getting search traffic."

Pain #2: Wasting time on WhatsApp

SOLUTION: "Your website has all the key info students need—fees, timings, prerequisites, instructor bios, reviews. They find the answer without asking."

HOW: "Plus, there's an online booking system. They click 'book a lesson,' choose their time, make payment, and boom—they're in your system. No WhatsApp back-and-forth."

Pain #3: No systems for growth

SOLUTION: "You get a student portal (they track progress, see lessons, make payments), an instructor portal (they manage schedules), and an admin dashboard (you see everything—revenue, students, leads, everything)."

HOW: "One centralized system instead of WhatsApp, Excel sheets, and confusion."

Step 3: Use Specific, Visual Language

Don't say: "You'll have a website with e-commerce integration."

DO say: "When a new student lands on your homepage, they'll see:

- Your story (why they should choose you)
- Your courses with clear pricing
- Your instructors with photos and bios
- Reviews from past students
- A big green 'Book Now' button
- They click it, pick their time, pay with Razorpay, and done. They're in your system."

Step 4: Show Them Social Proof

"I built a similar site for a gym in Bangalore. First month after launch, they got 12 new members from Google search. By month 3, it was 25-30 per month.

A coaching center used this same approach. They were getting 5 students per month. Now it's 15-18."

Why? Real examples (even if from other industries) build credibility.

Step 5: Make It About Them, Not You

❌ DON'T SAY: "I use React, Node, and PostgreSQL."

✅ DO SAY: "Everything is built for speed and security.

Students will load your site in under 2 seconds on any phone or computer."

Feature = Technical detail Benefit = What it does for them

Step 6: Bring It Back to ROI

"So let's say this brings you 3-5 extra students per month.

At ₹4000 per student, that's ₹12-20K extra per month.

Within one month, you've made back your investment.

After that, it's all profit."

PHASE 4 CHECKLIST:

- [ ] You recapped their pain first
- [ ] You explained how your solution solves EACH pain point
- [ ] You used specific, visual language (not technical jargon)
- [ ] You showed social proof from real clients
- [ ] You focused on benefits, not features
- [ ] You tied it back to ROI
- [ ] You asked clarifying questions ("Does that make sense?")

PHASE 5: PRICING & TERMS (20-25 Minutes)

Your Goal

Present the cost in a way that feels like an investment, not an expense. Show ROI first, THEN ask for money.

The Rule: Show Value Before You Ask for Money

Never say "It costs ₹20K" without context. Always say "It costs ₹20K, which brings you ₹12-20K extra revenue per month."

How to Present Pricing

Step 1: Remind Them of the ROI (Again)

"Okay, so before we talk about investment, let me make sure

the math is clear in your head.

If this brings you 3-5 extra students per month—and based on

what I've seen with similar schools, that's conservative—at

₹4000 per student, that's ₹12-20K extra per month.

Make sense?"

They'll nod.

Step 2: Present the Full Cost Clearly

"Alright. So here's the investment:

ONE TIME: ₹20,000 for the website build and launch

MONTHLY: ₹2,500/month for maintenance starting month 2

Total year 1: ₹20K + (₹2.5K × 11 months) = ₹47.5K

In month 1, you make back ₹12-20K from new students.

By month 3, you've made back ₹36-60K in new revenue.

So the investment is really just the first month's delay.

After that, it's all profit."

Why This Works:

- You're specific (not "affordable pricing")
- You show WHEN they make money back
- You frame it as investment, not cost
- You quantify the profit

Step 3: Address the Payment Terms

"Here's how it works:

- 50% payment (₹10K) to start building
- 50% payment (₹10K) when it's ready to go live
- After that, ₹2.5K/month for maintenance, billed in advance

You own the domain, the code, everything. You can leave anytime after that. You're not locked in."

Step 4: Offer Options (If They Push Back on Price)

Option 1: Payment Plan

"If ₹20K upfront is tight, I can do:

- ₹5K/month for 4 months instead of ₹20K upfront
- Plus ₹2.5K/month maintenance starting month 2"

Option 2: Scaled Pricing

"If you want a simpler site (no student portal, just basic booking + info), I can do ₹12K instead of ₹20K."

Option 3: Performance-Based

"Here's another option—I can do ₹10K upfront, and then you pay me ₹500 per new student I bring you (up to ₹10K). If you get 20 new students, you pay me ₹10K and we're even."

(Risky for you, but shows confidence)

Step 5: Get Clarity on Budget

If they haven't said yes yet, ask directly:

"Is budget the main thing holding you back, or are there

other concerns?"

If they say "budget":

"Alright. What would make this feel like a better investment?

Is it ₹15K instead of ₹20K? Is it seeing the demo first?

Is it talking to another client?"

Then solve for that specific thing.

Step 6: Address Competing Priorities

They might say: "I want to do this, but I also want to invest in marketing."

Response:

"That makes sense. But here's the thing—marketing brings people

to your website. If you don't have a website, where are they going?

They bounce.

So this isn't competing with marketing. It's the foundation that

makes your marketing work."

PHASE 5 CHECKLIST:

- [ ] You showed ROI BEFORE asking for money
- [ ] You were specific about costs (not vague)
- [ ] You broke down payment terms clearly
- [ ] You addressed the "when do I make money back?" question
- [ ] You offered options if they pushed back

- [ ] You asked directly about budget concerns
- [ ] You didn't get defensive about price

PHASE 6: THE CLOSE (25-30 Minutes)

Your Goal

Get a clear YES, a clear NO, or a concrete next step. NOT vague.

The Rule: Ask for Commitment

Don't end the call without knowing what happens next.

Three Types of Closes

CLOSE TYPE 1: The Demo Close

Use this if: They're interested but not ready to commit.

"Alright, so you're interested. I don't want you to commit

to anything yet. What I DO want is to show you exactly how

this would work for YOUR driving school.

I've built a demo—custom to your school. You'll see:

- How students find you on Google

- What your homepage looks like

- How the booking system works

- Your student portal

- Your admin dashboard

Takes 20-30 minutes. After that, you'll know if this is for you.

When works—Friday at 3 PM, or next Monday morning?"

If they say yes: Lock it in.

"Perfect. Friday 3 PM. I'll send you a Zoom link.

You'll see the demo, I'll answer questions, and then

we'll figure out next steps. Fair?"

CLOSE TYPE 2: The Direct Close

Use this if: They're excited and ready to buy NOW.

"Okay, so here's what I'm hearing—you see the value,

you understand the ROI, and you want to move forward.

Are you ready to sign the agreement and get started?"

If they say yes:

"Perfect. Here's the agreement. Let me walk you through

the key points... [go through contract] ...You good with all of that?"

[Get signature or verbal agreement]

"Alright, we're happening. Here's the timeline:

- I start building this week
- We'll have a demo ready for you in 5-7 days
- You'll have 3 days to review and test
- We go live in 10-12 days
- SEO fully optimized in 5 days after that

Fair?"

CLOSE TYPE 3: The Stall Management Close

Use this if: They say "Let me think about it."

"I totally get it. You want to make sure this is the right move.

Quick question though—is there anything else you need to know

or see before you can decide? Is it:

A) Seeing the demo and how it works?

B) Talking to another driving school owner?

C) Understanding the contract better?

D) Something else?"

They'll pick one.

"Alright, let's solve that right now. [Do that thing]

So given that [you saw the demo / talked to a client / reviewed the contract], does it make sense to move forward?"

If still hesitant:

"Look, I'm not trying to push you. But I want to be real—this is the moment to decide.

If you wait 3 months and then think 'I should have done that,' you'll have lost 3 months of Google traffic and customers.

So let's decide NOW. Is this a yes, a no, or a 'let me do the demo first'?"

How to Handle a "NO"

If they say no, don't just disappear. Do this:

"No worries. Just so I know for future reference—is this a 'not right now' or a 'not ever'?"

If "not right now":

"Got it. What would change your mind? Is it:

- Doing better financially?

- Seeing it work for a competitor?

- Me checking back in 6 months?"

If "not ever":

"All good. One last thing though—do you know anyone else running a business around here who might benefit from this? Even if you don't want it, would you mind if I reached out to them?"

Why? You turn a "no" into a referral opportunity. Always.

Locking In the Next Step

Whatever the outcome, make it SPECIFIC:

Vague (BAD):

"Cool, let me follow up with you in a couple weeks."

Specific (GOOD):

"Perfect. Here's the plan:

- Friday 3 PM, I send you the Zoom link for the demo
- You spend 25 minutes watching
- Sunday afternoon, I call you at 2 PM and we discuss
- If you want to move forward, we sign the agreement that week

Does that timeline work?"

PHASE 6 CHECKLIST:

- [ ] You asked for a clear commitment (yes, no, or next step)
- [ ] You didn't leave it vague
- [ ] You locked in a specific date/time for next step
- [ ] If they said "let me think," you identified the blocker
- [ ] If they said no, you asked why and tried to salvage
- [ ] You showed respect for their decision

- [ ] You got a phone number / email for follow-up

COMMON MISTAKES & HOW TO FIX THEM

MISTAKE 1: Pitching Before Understanding

The Problem: You jump into explaining your website before understanding their pain.

Why It Happens: You're nervous. You want to show how smart you are.

How to Fix It: Ask 3-5 discovery questions BEFORE you talk about your product. Let them admit the problem first.

❌ WRONG: "I build websites with SEO and online booking."

✅ RIGHT: "How are you currently getting new customers?"

[Listen]

"What's the biggest frustration in your day-to-day operations?"

[Listen]

"So if I could solve those two problems, would it be worth looking at?"

MISTAKE 2: Using Industry Jargon

The Problem: You say "SEO," "WCAG compliance," "Razorpay MDR," and they nod but don't understand.

Why It Happens: You know the technical stuff. You assume they care about the technical stuff.

How to Fix It: Translate jargon into benefits.

❌ WRONG: "We'll optimize your site with SEO best practices and structured data markup."

✅ RIGHT: "When a student Googles 'driving school near me,' Google's algorithm will see your site as a perfect match and show it first."

MISTAKE 3: Inconsistent Numbers

The Problem: You say ₹500/hour for changes, then your contract says ₹250/hour. Or you say "2-5 customers" and later say "5-10."

Why It Happens: You're winging it. You don't have your numbers written down.

How to Fix It: Before EVERY call, write down:

- Your pricing (one-time cost, monthly cost, hourly rate)
- Your promises (timeline, expected results, terms)
- Your numbers (your experience, case studies)

Then read off your notes if needed. It's professional, not sketchy.

MISTAKE 4: Making Promises You Can't Keep

The Problem: You say "I guarantee you'll be #1 on Google" or "You'll get 10 new customers per month."

Why It Happens: You're desperate to close the deal.

How to Fix It: Use conservative numbers and realistic timelines.

❌ WRONG: "You'll get 20 new students per month from this."

✅ RIGHT: "Based on what I've seen, you can expect 3-5 per month in the first 3 months, growing from there."

Always under-promise and over-deliver.

MISTAKE 5: Not Addressing Their Real Objection

The Problem: They say "I can't afford it," and you lower your price. But what they MEANT was "I don't believe it'll work."

Why It Happens: You assume "can't afford" = budget problem. Sometimes it means trust problem.

How to Fix It: Ask clarifying questions.

"You said cost is the issue. Let me ask though—if you could see

it working first (with a demo), would that change things? Or is

budget genuinely the blocker?"

Address the REAL objection, not the surface one.

MISTAKE 6: Disappearing After "Let Me Think"

The Problem: They say "I'll think about it" and you never follow up, or follow up too soft.

Why It Happens: You respect their time. You don't want to seem pushy.

How to Fix It: Follow up with a specific reason to re-engage.

Day 1 (After call): Send a thank-you email with the demo link

Day 3: "Hey, did you get a chance to check out the demo?

Any questions?"

Day 7: "I wanted to check in—did you decide to move forward,

or do you have lingering questions?"

Day 14: "No pressure, but I had another prospect ask about

something similar, and it made me think of your situation.

Want to hop on a quick call?"

Each follow-up has a purpose. Not just "any updates?"

MISTAKE 7: Not Owning Your Mistakes

The Problem: You say something wrong and pretend you didn't.

Why It Happens: You're embarrassed.

How to Fix It: Acknowledge immediately and correct.

"Wait, I said ₹500/hour earlier, and the contract says ₹250.

That's my mistake—I copied this from a different contract.

For a driving school website, the actual rate is ₹250/hour.

Let me send you an updated version."

This builds trust, not breaks it. People respect honesty.

MISTAKE 8: Talking Too Much

The Problem: You go on and on about features, and they zone out.

Why It Happens: You're nervous. You fill silence.

How to Fix It: For every point you make, ask a question.

"So here's how the booking system works—[explain in 30 seconds]

Does that make sense? Any questions on that part?"

"And you'd have a student portal where they track progress—

[30 seconds]. Would that solve the tracking problem you mentioned?"

Make it conversational, not a presentation.

MISTAKE 9: Not Following Up After a "YES"

The Problem: You close the deal, they sign, and then... nothing. You're slow to start.

Why It Happens: You're tired. You move to the next prospect.

How to Fix It: Have a handoff process.

1. They sign contract

2. Within 24 hours: You send questionnaire (business info, photos, bios, etc.)

3. Within 3 days: You send design mockups for approval

4. Within 7 days: They approve, you start building

5. Throughout: Weekly check-ins on progress

Keep momentum. Don't go silent.

MISTAKE 10: Not Tracking What Works

The Problem: You finish 10 calls and can't remember what worked and what didn't.

Why It Happens: You don't have a system.

How to Fix It: After every call, note:

DATE: 1/15

BUSINESS: Driving School

NAME: Raj

RESULT: Demo locked for Friday 3 PM (YES)

WHAT WORKED: Asked about Google visibility—he admitted he

didn't know if he showed up. That opened him up.

WHAT DIDN'T: My first opening was generic. I should have

said "I've worked with 4 driving schools."

SCORE: 8.3/10

NEXT: Send demo link, prep presentation

Over time, you'll see patterns. Use them to improve.

HOW TO ADAPT TO DIFFERENT SCENARIOS

Every business is different. Here's how to adapt your pitch.

SCENARIO A: BUSINESS WITH NO WEBSITE

Their Situation:

- No online presence
- Customers find them word-of-mouth or walk-in only
- They don't know what they're missing

Your Approach:

Phase 2 Discovery Focus:

- "What happens when someone searches for you on Google?"
- "How many customers do you think search online before choosing?"
- "Where would you WANT customers to find you?"

Phase 4 Solution Focus:

- Paint the picture: "Imagine a student Googles 'driving lessons near me' and YOUR school shows up first."
- Emphasize visibility: "You become findable, searchable, professional-looking."
- Emphasize simplicity: "It's one central place for all your info."

Close Strategy: Demo close works best. They need to see it to believe it.

SCENARIO B: BUSINESS WITH OUTDATED WEBSITE

Their Situation:

- They HAVE a website, but it's old, ugly, doesn't work on mobile, no booking, etc.
- They've been burned before (maybe a developer who disappeared)
- They're hesitant to invest again

Your Approach:

Phase 2 Discovery Focus:

- "When was your website built?"
- "What's frustrating about it now?"
- "Have you thought about rebuilding, or are you waiting for something to change?"

Phase 3 Objection Strategy:

- They might say "I've already invested in a website."
- Response: "I get it. Question—how many bookings are you getting from it per month?"
- If low or zero: "So it's taking up space but not making you money. What if we rebuilt it to actually convert?"

Phase 4 Solution Focus:

- Emphasize improvement: "Your current site does X. Our new site does X, Y, and Z."
- Show specific upgrades: Mobile-friendly, faster loading, online booking, Google integration, etc.
- Use comparison: Show them their old site on mobile (it's probably broken). Show a new site. Visual proof.

Close Strategy: Direct close or demo close. They're more likely to commit if they see the improvement.

SCENARIO C: BUSINESS WITH GOOD WEBSITE (You're trying to upsell)

Their Situation:

- They have a website that works okay
- But they're not optimizing for more bookings, more revenue, etc.

- They don't know what "better" looks like

Your Approach:

Phase 2 Discovery Focus:

- "How many bookings/customers come from your website per month?"
- "What would double or triple that be worth to you?"
- "What's holding you back from getting more online customers?"

Phase 4 Solution Focus:

- Emphasize growth: "You're getting 5 customers. What if we optimized and got 15?"
- Use data: "Based on the traffic analysis, you're getting X visitors but only Y conversions. Here's why and how to fix it."

Close Strategy: ROI close. They already see some value, so emphasize the upside.

SCENARIO D: PRICE-SENSITIVE BUSINESS (Low margins)

Their Situation:

- They have low budgets
- Every rupee matters
- They need to see immediate ROI

Your Approach:

Phase 5 Pricing Strategy:

- Lead with ROI, not cost: "This costs ₹20K, which pays for itself in month 1 from new revenue."
- Offer payment plans: "₹5K/month for 4 months instead of ₹20K upfront."
- Offer phased approach: "Let's start with the basics for ₹12K. We can add features later."

Phase 4 Solution Focus:

- Emphasize efficiency: "This saves you 2 hours a day. That's 10 hours a week. What's your time worth?"
- Emphasize revenue: "This brings you 3-5 extra customers at ₹X each. That's ₹Y extra per month."

Close Strategy: Performance-based close: "You pay me ₹X per customer I bring you." This shows you believe in the ROI.

SCENARIO E: SKEPTICAL/BURNED BEFORE

Their Situation:

- They've been scammed or disappointed by a developer before
- They're defensive
- They need proof and transparency

Your Approach:

Phase 1-2 Strategy:

- Be extra transparent about what you can and can't guarantee
- Admit what you don't know
- Show your limitations: "I don't have a case study in YOUR specific niche yet."

Phase 3 Objection Strategy:

- They'll ask for proof. Offer multiple types:
    - A demo built to their specs
    - References from other clients (actual phone numbers, not testimonials you wrote)
    - A contract they can review with a lawyer
    - A trial period or performance-based fee

Phase 5 Terms Strategy:

- Be extra clear about ownership: "You own the domain, the code, everything."
- Be extra clear about exit: "You can leave anytime. Here's how the handoff works."
- Be extra clear about support: "First 60 days, I fix all bugs free. After that, it's maintenance only."

Close Strategy: Slow close. Don't rush them. Let them see the demo, talk to references, review the contract. Then decide.

TRACKING & IMPROVEMENT

How to Know if You're Getting Better

Metrics to Track After Every Call

Create a simple spreadsheet:

DATE | BUSINESS TYPE | DECISION | LENGTH | TOTAL SCORE | DISCOVERY | OBJECTION | CLOSE | NOTES

-----|---------------|----------|--------|-------------|-----------|-----------|-------|-------

1/15 | Driving School| YES-DEMO | 25min | 8.3/10 | 9/10 | 7/10 | 9/10 | Asked about Google visibility. Made assumption about price.

1/16 | Gym | MAYBE | 30min | 7.0/10 | 8/10 | 6/10 | 7/10 | Wasn't specific about ROI. Need better numbers.

1/17 | Salon | NO | 15min | 5.5/10 | 6/10 | 5/10 | 5/10 | Pitched too early. Didn't understand pain.

What to Track

Conversion Rate:

How many calls → Yes/Demo Locked?

Target: 80% lock a demo, 40% close into paying clients

Call Quality Score:

Average score across all phases

Target: Start at 6/10, improve to 9/10 over 20 calls

Time Efficiency:

How long does it take to get a yes?

Target: Under 30 minutes

Objection Handling:

Which objections do you handle well? (Your score)

Which do you struggle with? (Your score)

Example: You're great at pricing objections (9/10) but weak at skepticism objections (6/10)

Monthly Review

After 10-20 calls, analyze:

1. What objections come up most? (Track them)

2. Which closes work best? (Demo close? Direct close?)

3. Which discovery questions get the best responses?

4. Where do I lose people? (Which phase?)

5. What business types convert best? (Driving schools? Gyms?)

6. What's my average deal size and close time?

Then optimize based on this data.

How to Get Better (Weekly Practice)

Do this every week:

1. **Record one call** (with permission) and listen to it
    - What did you do well?
    - Where did you fumble?
    - What would you say differently?
2. **Run a practice conversation with a friend or mentor**
    - Gives you feedback in real-time
    - Identifies weak spots
    - Builds confidence
3. **Watch a great sales conversation** (YouTube, podcasts, examples)
    - What moves did they make?
    - Can you steal them?
    - What would you do differently?
4. **Read your notes from last week's calls**
    - What patterns do you see?
    - What's working?
    - What needs work?

How to Level Up From 6/10 to 9/10

Weeks 1-2: Foundation

- Master the 6 phases
- Ask the right discovery questions
- Handle common objections

Weeks 3-4: Refinement

- Personalize your pitch to each business type
- Get faster at identifying real pain
- Improve your closes

Weeks 5-8: Optimization

- A/B test different approaches
- Find your rhythm
- Build confidence

Weeks 9-12: Mastery

- Close at 60-70% rate
- Lock demos in under 30 minutes
- Handle objections like a pro

FINAL CHECKLIST: ARE YOU READY?

Before you make your first real sales call, check:

PRE-CALL PREP:

- [ ] You researched the business on Google
- [ ] You identified their likely pain points
- [ ] You wrote down your opening line
- [ ] You wrote down 3-5 discovery questions
- [ ] You have your pricing/terms memorized
- [ ] You have a contract ready (even if blank)

MINDSET:

- [ ] You're not desperate to sell
- [ ] You're genuinely curious about their business
- [ ] You're okay with hearing "no"
- [ ] You're not going to pitch until you understand their pain
- [ ] You're comfortable with silence (let them talk)

SKILLS:

- [ ] You can ask open-ended questions
- [ ] You can listen without interrupting
- [ ] You can reframe objections (not argue)
- [ ] You can quantify ROI
- [ ] You can close with a specific next step

TOOLS:

- [ ] You have a calendar link to share (for demo)
- [ ] You have your contract ready
- [ ] You have case studies or references
- [ ] You have a demo or website examples to show
- [ ] You have a CRM or simple tracking sheet

QUICK REFERENCE CARD

Print this and keep it handy during calls:

PHASE 1: OPENING (0-2 min)

- Be specific about business type

- Show you researched them

- Ask for small commitment (5 min)

PHASE 2: DISCOVERY (2-8 min)

- Ask about customer acquisition

- Ask about operational pain

- Ask "magic wand" question

- Don't pitch yet

PHASE 3: OBJECTION HANDLING (8-15 min)

- Validate their concern first

- Ask clarifying questions

- Address the REAL objection

- Offer proof or alternative

PHASE 4: SOLUTION (15-20 min)

- Recap their pain

- Show how you solve each pain

- Use specific, visual language

- Tie back to ROI

PHASE 5: PRICING (20-25 min)

- Show ROI before asking for money

- Be specific about costs

- Address payment terms

- Offer options if needed

PHASE 6: CLOSE (25-30 min)

- Ask for clear commitment

- Lock in specific next step

- If "let me think," find the blocker

- If "no," ask why and get referral

FINAL WORDS

This framework works because it respects the buyer.

You're not tricking them into buying. You're:

1. Understanding their world
2. Showing them what they're missing
3. Proving you can help
4. Making it easy to say yes

If you follow this structure, stay honest, and actually care about solving their problem, you'll close deals. Not all of them. But enough.

Good luck. 🚀